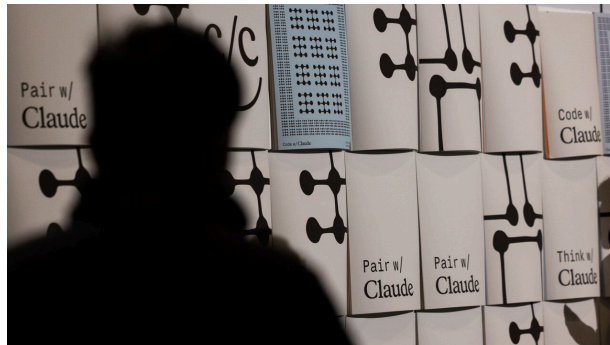


## World in Brief: Anthropic's reprieve; Donald Trump's crypto bonanza



Photograph: Getty Images

America's Commerce Department lifted **export controls** on all of **Anthropic's** artificial-intelligence models. Last month officials ordered [Anthropic](#) to ban foreigners from accessing its latest Mythos and Fable models, citing safety concerns. The decision forced Anthropic to cut off access to the models for its users. The firm says it has put in place "a new safeguard" to satisfy the Trump administration.

**Donald Trump** earned more than \$1bn from his **cryptocurrency** ventures in 2025, according to a new disclosure. Around half of that amount came from token sales at his family's crypto firm, World Liberty Financial. The president also raked in another \$1bn or so from his other businesses, including his property empire. The White House said "neither the president nor his family has ever engaged—or will ever engage—in [conflicts of interest](#)".

**Iran's** parliamentary speaker said that direct talks with **America** would not include discussions of a final deal until terms of the [memorandum of understanding](#) were fully met. Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf warned that Iran was "prepared for war" if "dialogue is not implemented". Earlier **Qatar's** foreign ministry said America's envoys would hold lower-level talks with Qatari mediators this week.

Meanwhile **Binyamin Netanyahu**, Israel's prime minister, asserted that his country's armed forces would not leave southern **Lebanon** until Hizbullah, [an Iran-backed militia](#), "is eliminated". Mr Netanyahu visited the occupied territory on Tuesday. Separately, America's House of Representatives failed to pass a war-powers resolution that would have required Congress to approve any American involvement in Israeli military operations in Lebanon.

The EU introduced a €3 (\$3.4) fee on low-value imports, ending a duty-free exemption for parcels valued under €150. The move targets Chinese e-commerce brands like Temu and Shein. Officials said that 5.8bn such parcels entered the bloc last year, up from 1.4bn in 2022. In 2025 America ended [a similar exemption](#) for packages worth less than \$800.

**Afghanistan** launched strikes at targets in **Pakistan** as [tensions escalated](#) between the neighbours. The attack followed Pakistani air strikes on Sunday, which the UN said killed at least 28 Afghan civilians. Russia urged both sides to resolve their differences through "diplomatic means". The countries had agreed to a ceasefire last year, but fighting has continued since then.

**France** swept past Sweden to book a place in the round of 16 at the **World Cup**. Kylian Mbappé scored twice in a comfortable 3-0 win for the tournament favourites. The Frenchman has now drawn level with Lionel Messi as this tournament's top scorer. Norway and Mexico also progressed to the next round. England will hope to join them on Wednesday, when they face Congo.

**Figure of the day:** Six, the number of goals Lionel Messi and Kylian Mbappé have scored so far at the 2026 World Cup. Our [Back Story](#) columnist examines why this year's tournament belongs to football's superstars.

## US in Brief: Born this way



Photograph: Reuters

The **Supreme Court** struck down Donald Trump's executive order to end **birthright citizenship** for babies born in America to undocumented or temporary migrants, declaring it unconstitutional. Mr Trump subsequently suggested, inaccurately, that he can "easily make it up in Congress through Legislation". (Such a law would face significant legal hurdles.) The president **had better luck** regarding state bans on transgender athletes competing in women's sport: all nine justices agreed they can be excluded under a federal civil-rights law. The conservative majority also relaxed restrictions on campaign spending.

Members of the **House of Representatives** headed home early after right-wing Republicans voted down a procedural motion, stalling the week's legislative agenda. Conservatives want Republican leaders to advance Mr Trump's **save America Act**, which seeks to end most mail-in ballots and to require voters to present proof of citizenship and photo identification, as well as a border-security bill. Separately, the House failed to pass a war-powers resolution that would have required Congress to approve any American involvement in Israeli military operations in Lebanon.

The progressive wing of the Democratic Party continued its **winning streak**. In **Colorado's** Democratic primary for governor,

Phil Weiser, the attorney-general, defeated Michael Bennet, a prominent senator (whose brother writes for *The Economist*), after casting Mr Bennet as a Washington insider—an upset that signals voter frustration with establishment figures. Meanwhile, Melat Kiros, a 29-year-old, defeated Diana DeGette, a 29-year incumbent, in the 1st District’s House primary. Manny Rutinel, a progressive state representative, also ousted Shannon Bird, a moderate former state representative, in the 8th.

The **Food and Drug Administration** allowed some **Zyn nicotine pouches** to be marketed to adults as safer than cigarettes, by claiming their use carries a lower risk of diseases including lung cancer and heart disease. The smoke-free products made by **Philip Morris International**, a tobacco giant, were authorised for sale last year. They are the first nicotine pouches to receive the designation.

# Taking stock of the Supreme Court



Photograph: Getty Images

America's Supreme Court wrapped up its term with mixed results for Donald Trump's agenda. It upheld state bans, favoured by the administration, on [transgender athletes competing in women's sport](#): all nine justices agreed that biological males can be excluded from female sports under Title IX, a federal civil-rights law that bans sex discrimination in schools. All but three added that such bans do not violate the constitution. The conservative majority also relaxed restrictions on campaign spending.

The president was less thrilled about the court's 6-3 decision to strike down his [executive order to end birthright citizenship](#) for babies born in America to noncitizens. He wrote online, inaccurately, that he can "easily make it up in Congress through Legislation". Still, this defeat could not obscure the term's conservative bottom line: ruling in *Trump v Slaughter* on Monday, justices [handed him more power](#) by allowing him to fire commissioners of independent agencies at will. Mr Trump concluded that his party "was treated very fairly" by the court.

# Germany's coalition attempts a reboot



Photograph: Shutterstock

If you feel sorry for Germany's footballers, ejected from the World Cup by Paraguay on Monday, spare a thought for the country's politicians. A promised "autumn of reforms" last year fizzled out, Germany's economy **remains stuck** and its coalition, which unites Friedrich Merz's conservatives with the Social Democrats, has **squabbled endlessly**. On Wednesday senior figures from the ruling parties hope to reboot with a meeting designed to agree on tax, labour-market and other reforms.

Last week moods improved when the parties agreed that reforms to Germany's pension system, proposed by a state-backed commission, should be implemented in full. But the topics on Wednesday's agenda, especially how to fund tax cuts for low earners, could prove harder to solve. What was supposed to be a one-day session could drag on, possibly into Friday. Going to extra time, if that is what it takes, beats going home.

# Bending Spoons lists for American IPO



Photograph: Getty Images

Bending Spoons, a conglomerate based in Milan, will list its shares on America's tech-heavy Nasdaq exchange on Wednesday. The IPO values the company at around \$18bn, in what would be a rare [European-tech](#) success story.

Bending Spoons buys ailing digital businesses at low prices and fixes them up. It has done so for around 50 companies since its founding in 2013, including Vimeo, a video platform, and WeTransfer, a file-sharing service. The firm's revenue comes from monthly subscriptions for its apps, and has grown from \$387m in 2023 to \$1.3bn in 2025. But a recent buying spree has loaded the firm with debt. And some of the older digital brands it forked out for are under threat from artificial intelligence. Bending Spoons says AI is actually an opportunity, noting improvements in its productivity and marketing. The firm's stock-market debut will show if investors are convinced.



# India revamps a big rural safety net



Photograph: Getty Images

For two decades, the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act has been the cornerstone of India's rural-development strategy. The programme guarantees 100 days of minimum-wage employment on public works for every rural household that asks for it. Despite patchy implementation, the scheme had nearly 60m households participate in 2024-25. Studies show it is an effective safety net that also boosts rural incomes and empowers women.

On Wednesday MGNREGA was to be replaced by a new programme, known as VB-G RAM G, which India's government insists will improve on the old one by increasing the number of days of work available. Critics, however, say it is a downgrade that erodes its predecessor's legal guarantees. State governments will have to pay more than they are currently to fund the scheme; several are considering challenging the change in the Supreme Court. Meanwhile forecasters are predicting a [historically weak monsoon](#) in the coming weeks, which will strain rural livelihoods—and put the new programme to the test.



# The lure of the rising sun



Photograph: Getty Images

For the past two years the World Travel Index has deemed Japan the world's best destination. Last year a record 42.7m holiday-goers visited the country. But tourists may soon sense they are less welcome. From Wednesday Japan's government will raise the visa fee from ¥3,000 (\$19) to ¥15,000 (\$92)—the first increase in nearly 50 years.

The decision is a response to a [souring mood](#). Overtourism has become a political issue, in part thanks to Sanseito, a small populist-right party. Viral clips of unruly visitors, like one of a tourist doing pull-ups on the sacred *torii* gate of a shrine, have provoked outrage. But the higher visa fee may not deter visitors. The lure of Japanese culture remains strong. The value of the yen has fallen to 162 to the dollar, a 40-year low. Holiday-makers will have to pay a bit more to enter Japan, but they'll save money while they're there.

## Tokyo drift

Yen per \$, Inverted scale



Source: Haver Analytics

# Daily quiz



Illustration: Sandra Navarro

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 BST on Friday to [\[email protected\]](#). We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

**Wednesday:** Arthur Wellesley, a British field marshal, is better known by his aristocratic title. What is it?

**Tuesday:** Which actor played Roseanne Barr's husband in the sitcom *Roseanne*?

*He who hasn't tasted bitter things  
hasn't earned sweet things.*

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***Gottfried Wilhelm Leibniz***